

associate with almost 38 compressed file types including Bz2, jar, tar, tgz, bin, etc. This feature makes the utility a boon for people who have to constantly switch between Windows and Linux.



ALZip has a plain user interface

Standard features such as file compression, self-extracting archives and spanning are provided; however, don't expect any fancy features such as one-click backup.

What we liked about ALZip is its blazing fast performance; it took just 35 seconds to compress the same 204 MB file to 202 MB.

If you're confident about your computer skills, and are willing to trade fancy looks for geeky functionality, we'd suggest ALZip over ZipGenius.

8.2.3 7-Zip

7-Zip is well known for its 7z compression format, which has a high compression ratio. In fact, files compressed in the 7z format tend to be 30 to 50 per cent smaller than the corresponding ZIP files. 7-Zip supports around 13 compression formats, which include ZIP, TAR, and GZ, as well as its own 7z format. It can also archive files in the TAR and GZ format, unlike WinZip, which can only archive in the ZIP format. 7-Zip integrates with the file manager and automatically associates with compressed files on your system.

The user interface is a notch below ALZip, with no self-explanatory icons - just the context menu. The good part is that you can